PHP AND WORDPRESS DEVELOPMENT · QUICK SETUP

Get Ready in Under an Hour

Before the first session: install **Docker**, unpack the course project **pagesco-dev**, start it, install **WordPress 7.1 on PHP 8.5**, run the check. You need a laptop with 8 GB of memory, about 10 GB free, and a code editor (VS Code). The first start downloads about 3 GB: do it at home. Stuck? The full **Setup Guide** covers every problem, the offline images and the Part 2 setup (Node 24, Composer, the Part 2 starting site).

1 · INSTALL DOCKER (PICK ONE)

- **Windows 10/11:** in PowerShell as administrator `wsl --install`, restart, create your Ubuntu user. Install **Docker Desktop** (WSL 2 backend), then Settings ▸ Resources ▸ WSL integration ▸ switch on Ubuntu. Use the **Ubuntu** app for every command and keep the project in `~`, never under `/mnt/c/` (many times slower).
- **macOS:** install **Docker Desktop for Mac** (Apple silicon or Intel), start it once.
- **Linux:** Docker Engine + the Compose plugin from docs.docker.com/engine/install, then `sudo usermod -aG docker "$USER"` and log out and in.

Check: `docker compose version` (with a space) prints version 2 or newer.

2 · GET THE PROJECT

```
cd ~
curl -LO https://rays-php-wordpress.netlify.app/downloads/pagesco-dev.zip
unzip pagesco-dev.zip
cd pagesco-dev
```

No `unzip` on Ubuntu/WSL? `sudo apt install unzip`. **Linux and WSL only, before the first start** (so the files in `wordpress/` are yours, not uid 33's):

```
printf 'PAGESCO_UID=%s\nPAGESCO_GID=%s\n' "$(id -u)" "$(id -g)" > .env
cp config/compose.linux.yaml compose.override.yaml
mkdir wordpress
```

3 · START IT AND INSTALL WORDPRESS

```
docker compose up -d
docker compose run --rm wpcli wp core install --url=http://localhost:8080 --title="Pages & Co." -
-admin_user=admin --admin_password=password --admin_email=wordpress@example.com --skip-email
docker compose run --rm wpcli wp rewrite structure '/%postname%/'
```

Open **http://localhost:8080** (log in at `/wp-admin/` as admin / password). Then the **wp shortcut**; add the same line to `~/.bashrc` (macOS: `~/.zshrc`):

```
alias wp='docker compose --progress quiet run --rm wpcli wp'
```

4 · EMAIL AND LABS

```
mkdir -p wordpress/wp-content/mu-plugins
cp config/mailpit-smtp.php wordpress/wp-content/mu-plugins/
```

Mailpit shows the site's email at **http://localhost:8025**. Copy the `labs/` folder from your instructor into `pagesco-dev`, next to `compose.yaml` (not inside `wordpress/`).

5 · RUN THE CHECK

```
bash labs/module-01/l1_0-orientation/check_environment.sh
```

> ✅ **DONE WHEN THE LAST LINE SAYS READY FOR PHP AND WORDPRESS DEVELOPMENT**
>
> Send that line to your instructor. **READY WITH NOTES** is fine (read the CHECK lines: PHP 8.4, or a project on the Windows drive). **NOT READY**? Fix the FIX lines from the top (each names the step), run it again; still stuck: the full guide's problems table, or bring the output to Session 1's install clinic.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

YOU SEE…	TRY THIS
`port is already allocated`	Another container or server uses 8080 or 8025: `docker ps`, stop it.
`Permission denied` in `wordpress/wp-content`	Linux/WSL setup of step 2 missing: the Setup Guide's repair box.
`no configuration file provided`	Not in the project folder: `cd ~/pagesco-dev`. Anything else: the Setup Guide, or the course's troubleshooting.html and common-errors.html pages (rays-php-wordpress.netlify.app).

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